and social fields and for the promotion of human rights, and such other commissions as may be required for the performance of its functions.

Even specialized bodies such as the ILO, UNICEF, UNESCO and the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) are engaged in human rights protection in one form or the other.

The growth in United Nations human rights activities has seen an increase with the growth of the strength of the international human rights movement since the United Nations General Assembly adopted the Universal Declaration of Human Rights on 10 December 1948. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights, together with the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and its two Optional Protocols, and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, form the “International Bill of Human Rights”.

Alongside the development of international human rights law, a number of United Nations human rights bodies have been established to respond to changing human rights challenges. There are certain Charter-based bodies and eight treaty-based bodies which work towards the monitoring of human rights situations worldwide. These constitute the Human Rights Monitoring mechanisms under the UN. There is also the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) to support and assist these human rights monitoring mechanisms of the UN.

The **Charter-based bodies** include the former Commission on Human Rights, the Human Rights Council, Universal Periodic Review and Special Procedures. Between 1946–2006, the Human Rights Commission, which was established by the UN Economic and Social Council, was responsible for monitoring human rights protection. The Universal Declaration, the ICCPR, the ICESR all were formulated with active help from this body. However, in 2006 this Commission was replaced by the Human Rights Council.

Human Rights Council was created by the UNGA on 15 March 2006 by adopting the resolution A/RES/60/251 which replaced the Commission on Human Rights. It held its first meeting on 19 June 2006. This intergovernmental body, which meets in Geneva 10